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BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS FORUM

BEHIND THE TANK

Unveiling the successes and setbacks of Shark Tank Entrepreneurs/Contestants

VENTURE'S VOYAGE

SHARK

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INTRODUCTION

We're all too familiar with the nail-biting suspense, the exhilarating pitches, and the jaw-dropping deals struck in the tank. But what happens next? That's where "Behind the Tank" comes in. In this special segment, we're pulling back the curtain to uncover the untold stories of the entrepreneurs and contestants who've ventured into the Shark Tank, laying bare their remarkable successes and humbling setbacks.

Shark Tank is renowned for its high-stakes drama and intense negotiations, but what viewers often miss is the journey that unfolds long after the show airs. From securing a deal with a Shark to navigating the complexities of scaling a business, the path to success is riddled with challenges that extend far beyond the confines of the tank.

Through "Behind the Tank," we aim to provide an intimate glimpse into the lives of these courageous individuals who dared to chase their dreams on national television. We'll explore the pivotal moments, the pivotal decisions, and the personal sacrifices that have shaped their entrepreneurial endeavors. From the euphoria of striking a game-changing deal to the crushing disappointment of rejection, we'll uncover the raw emotions and hard-won lessons that define the Shark Tank experience.

But "Behind the Tank" isn't just about the triumphs—it's about resilience, determination, and the unwavering spirit of innovation that drives these entrepreneurs forward. Join us as we embark on a riveting journey through the highs and lows of Shark Tank, celebrating the grit and ingenuity of the human spirit that continues to inspire us all.

SHIVANI PURI
DIV- 11
FY MBA

NISH HAIR

Parul Gulati, a talented actress in the Bollywood industry, has graced both the small and big screens with her remarkable performances.she ventures into the world of entrepreneurship, founding “Nish Hair,”Nish Hair provides affordable and high-quality hair extensions to women across India, addressing a widespread need and empowering women to embrace their beauty with confidence.

Parul moved to Mumbai in 2010 to pursue acting while also studying at Mumbai University. She explored various aspects of the entertainment industry, including modeling and auditions, all while nurturing her passion for beauty and hair care. Mumbai's vibrant culture provided the backdrop for her journey. Parul's entry into Bollywood was marked by hard work and perseverance, understanding that success required more than just talent. Facing a downturn in her acting career, she found herself trimming her own hair at home, sparking the idea for her venture, "Nish Hair."

Introduced to hair extensions during a shoot for a production house, Parul recognized a gap in the market due to the expensive and unwieldy nature of available options. This sparked her entrepreneurial spirit, leading her to meticulously research and source premium human hair for her extensions. Leveraging her cosmetology background and industry experience, she created "Nish Hair," offering top-notch, affordable, and user-friendly extensions. This brand has quickly gained recognition for its commitment to quality, transparency, and affordability, establishing itself as a trusted name in the beauty industry.

Gulati works with two vendors who provide human hair bundles, handling coloring and basic preparation before manufacturing. Nish Hair offers 45 SKUs across four categories: volume, length, coverage, and style, with pricing varying based on specific requirements. They have an all-women team of 35 and aim to expand their presence in every city. Initially online, they've expanded to offline operations with a studio in Mumbai and plan to open another store in South Mumbai. They've also partnered with salons like Salon Sizzlin Scizzors in Jaipur to offer trials to customers, aiming for wider accessibility.

In 2022, Gulati appeared on Shark Tank and secured Rs 1 crore for 2% equity from Amit Jain, CEO and Co-Founder at CarDekho. Before the show, Nish Hair's monthly revenue was Rs 80 lakh, but it has since tripled. Despite misconceptions, she hasn't left acting; she manages both roles simultaneously. She emphasizes that women can pursue multiple endeavors concurrently, likening her dedication to acting to being married while considering Nish Hair her baby.

SHIVANI PURI
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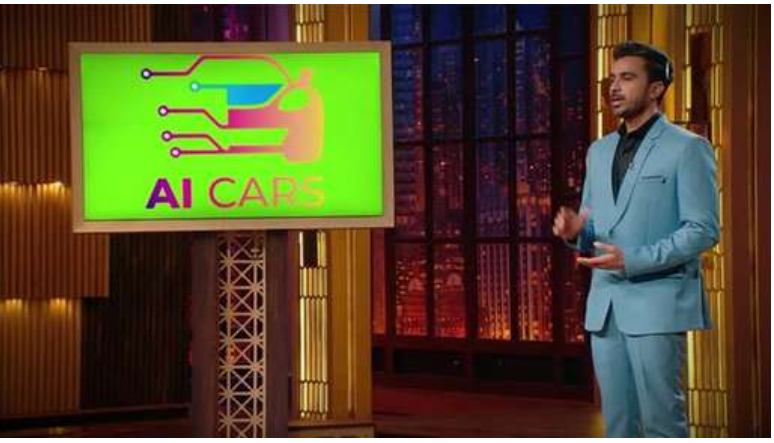
AI CARS



From building an AI car in his tiny garage, pitching it on Shark Tank India season three, to even impressing the judges, it was a dream run going on for Maharashtra's Harshal Mahadev Nakshane. But then came a twist.

In the recent of Shark Tank India season 3. Harshal Mahadev Nakshane of startup AI Cars, which bills itself as India's first artificially intelligent hydrogen-based vehicle manufacturing start-up, presented his pitch on the show. The 27-year-old, who hails from the small Maharashtra town of Yavatmal. revealed that he and his team built the car in 18 months in a small backyard garage of his house, and he asked for Rs 2 crore for 4% equity.

The prototype model, which required five minutes to refuel and has a range of over 1,000 km, is powered by a hydrogen fuel cell and was built for an estimated Rs 60 lakhs. Sharks were impressed by the ride, but none of them invested in his startup and rejected it because they thought he was sincere but overly ambitious, especially since he was combining AI with hydrogen in a nation with little infrastructure, little market, and few refueling stations.

Also, the judges, including Vineeta Singh, Namita Thapar, and Anupam Mittal, drove the AI car around Mumbai's Film City during the episode. Taking the wheel, the competitor himself showed off the car's autonomous abilities as it skillfully handled obstacles and sharp turns.

But there was a brief setback when the car had trouble navigating a steep ascent. Instead, the sharks advised Harshal to get a job at an automobile company and use his skills there to push for new and improved technology, rather than wasting his time building something on his own, which would have required "billions of dollars" rather than the Rs 2 cr that he was asking for.

ANISH KASHYAP
DIV - 8
FY MBA

KUNAFA WORLD

For any budding brand or company, a feature on the coveted reality show ‘Shark Tank India’ is like striking gold. The cherry on the cake is, of course, if you manage to bag a deal with the ‘Sharks’ and get a chance to work with them. It is a good way to get the much-needed exposure a company needs at the ground level because millions of eyes are on you as the show is aired on national television. If you are lucky, you get the funding and, in the process, you have an opportunity to gain some insights from the industry biggies who have been in business for a while.

Most of you might be aware of the Middle Eastern dessert kunafa, which is spun pastry layered with cheese, nuts, and sugar syrup. Even, let’s say six years back, this delectable Middle Eastern goodness was not widely popular and not something that you could easily grab from your confectionery next door. Thanks to Kunafa World founders Jameela Ruhi and Zamzeer Ahamed, now you can savor this Middle Eastern goodness in an outlet in your city. Jameela and Zamzeer knocked on the 'Shark Tank India' door in the first season of the show. “Although 'Sharks’ found the business model lucrative, they felt it was still in the early stages, so they backed out,” Zamzeer told India Today.

However, the rejection has not been a downer for the founders as they have expanded their business manifold since being featured.

“We don’t think the rejection has affected the business in any way. However, being featured on 'Shark Tank India' has opened us to a much wider audience and, even today, we are recognized as ‘Kunafa World’ from Shark Tank India’.

Also, we have gained some really insightful inputs from the ‘Sharks’ which we have applied in the business, and that has undoubtedly helped in our faster growth of expansion,” Ruhi said.
Speaking of the valuation, Zamzeer said, “Before being featured on ‘Shark Tank India’, the company’s valuation stood at Rs 18 crore. Post ‘Shark Tank India’, without any external funding, the company’s valuation has gone 5X with focus only on internal growth and more outlet expansions in the pipeline.”

PRACHI PUNJABI
DIV - 8
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“THE RISE AND FALL OF PHARMALLAMA: A SHARK TANK INVESTMENT GONE WRONG”

Founded by Arjun Raghunandan, Achintya Dayal, and Deepesh Rajpal, Pharmallama manufactures smart pill boxes that aims to revolutionize traditional pharmaceutical storage in Indian families by providing an organized and effective solution. Their smart pill box is designed to provide pre-arranged, sequenced sets of medication as per a doctor’s prescription, complete with an easy dispensing mechanism. Pharmallama also offers an accompanying app to help users track their medication and connect with healthcare experts. They launched in April 2022 and have already assisted more than 5,000 families.

Through a deal with ACG Pam Pac, one of the biggest packaging businesses in the world, they were able to raise ₹5 crore while diluting 50.9% of the business. At the moment, their pharmacy charges the maximum retail price (MRP) for medications. Pharmallama intends to sell it at a lower price than MRP.

Anupam initially offered ₹1 Crore for 2.22% equity. However, Peyush suggested a collaborative approach, and all the “sharks” joined forces, presenting a combined offer of ₹2 Crore for 5% of the company. Pharmallama initially countered with 5%, which the sharks rejected. Ultimately, they accepted the deal at a 5% equity share. Peyush commented that Pharmallama was his favorite among all the pitches on Shark Tank India.

Pharmallama announced that they had distributed over 300,000 medicines, but faced challenges when the Delhi Chemists Association issued a legal notice to Pharmallama, an e-pharma startup.

The association argued that e-pharmacies are not permitted under Indian laws and that no regulations allow the repackaging of medicines. A letter was sent to the startup founders and the Health Ministry, stating that Pharmallama's operations were illegal and should be ceased in the public interest. Since then, there have been no further developments on the matter. Pharmallama's social media presence went silent as of July 2023, suggesting potential legal battles. In December 2023, the company ultimately ceased its operations and proceeded with a formal shutdown.

MADHURA SHUKLA
DIV:- 6
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“THE RISE AND FALL OF DOORBOT: A LESSON IN ENTREPRENEURIAL RESILIENCE”

In the fast-paced world of entrepreneurship, every idea holds the potential for greatness, yet not all ventures reach the soaring heights they aspire to. Such was the case for DoorBot, a promising business that graced the Shark Tank stage with hopes of revolutionizing home security. While the journey of DoorBot ultimately ended in disappointment, its story offers invaluable lessons for budding entrepreneurs everywhere. Founded by a team of innovative minds, DoorBot aimed to provide homeowners with a convenient solution for monitoring their front doors remotely. Their smart doorbell allowed users to see and communicate with visitors through a smartphone app, promising enhanced security and convenience. With a compelling pitch and a product poised to disrupt the market, DoorBot entered the Shark Tank with high expectations.

However, despite its potential, DoorBot failed to secure investment from the Sharks. The reasons for its downfall were multifaceted – from concerns about market saturation to questions surrounding scalability and technological reliability. Ultimately, the Sharks decided to pass on the opportunity, leaving the DoorBot team to navigate the challenging waters of entrepreneurship alone.

While the outcome may have been disheartening, the DoorBot journey is not without its silver linings. The experience served as a valuable learning curve for the entrepreneurs involved, highlighting the importance of thorough market research, robust scalability plans, and effective communication strategies. Moreover, the DoorBot concept itself remains a testament to the power of innovation in addressing real-world problems.

As budding entrepreneurs, it's crucial to recognize that setbacks are an inherent part of the entrepreneurial journey. While not every idea will yield immediate success, it's how we respond to adversity that defines our path forward. In the case of DoorBot, the story may have ended prematurely, but the lessons learned will undoubtedly fuel future endeavors, inspiring resilience and innovation in the face of challenges.

VAISHNAVI SRIVASTAVA
DIV- 5
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“BLOG ON JDV METTLE INNOVATIONS PVT LTD.”

Guest name: Vrushali Deshpande (Co-founder)

- **What is the company all about.**

JDV Mettle innovations is a pioneering force in healthcare solutions. As a leading organization, we specialize in the establishment of cutting-edge milk banks across India. Also known as "Mettle Innovations" or simply "Mettle," our commitment is evident in our dedication to transforming healthcare landscapes. At JVD Mettle Innovations Pvt Ltd, we pride ourselves on providing end-to-end solutions for the setup and management of milk banks, ensuring the well-being of infants and mothers nationwide. We are more than a company; we are a catalyst for positive change in healthcare. Choose JVD Mettle Innovations Pvt Ltd for a transformative journey toward a healthier India. Our strong commitments sets us apart in the industry."

- **Who is the founder.**

Mrs. Vrushali Deshpande with her husband thought of an idea whose entire objective was to solve this Particular issue at a larger level, after years of teaching experience in field of pharma they both decided to establish their own business.

Mrs. Vrushali has been always in good ties with MIT-WPU and have allied her objectives with our institution for the welfare of the students. She is a Ted talks speaker as well as she had visited our campus for R.I.D.E. event.

Podcast episode link:
https://youtu.be/jUCZSy4WnEk?si=Stj4DLlg9q_XxXNo

“FROM SHARK TANK TO PERSONALIZED HAIRCARE SUCCESS: THE INSPIRATIONAL JOURNEY OF RAVEL”

Codify Infotech’s Ravel has created a stir in the beauty business with its novel approach to personalized haircare. This article dives into Ravel's history, from its birth to its appearance on Shark Tank, showing the company's growth and success in providing tailored solutions to consumers.

Ravel's story began with a mission to change the way people handled haircare by offering personalized products based on their specific needs. The brand's focus to employing natural products and avoiding dangerous chemicals distinguishes it in a market dominated by one-size-fits-all solutions. With a focus on openness and customer happiness, Ravel swiftly built a loyal following of customers looking for tailored haircare solutions.

Ravel's big break came when the brand got a slot on the popular TV show Shark Tank, where entrepreneurs pitch their company ideas to a group of investors. Ravel's appearance on Shark Tank not only gave a platform for showcasing its unique features, but also drew the attention of industry professionals and customers alike. The brand's pitch, which emphasized the benefits of personalized haircare and the wide range of alternatives available, resonated with the Sharks and viewers, resulting in a good outcome.

Ravel's personalized haircare products saw an increase in demand after appearing on Shark Tank. The brand's commitment to quality, innovation, and a customer-centric strategy proven to be a winning combination, propelling growth and profitability. With over 16,000 5-star ratings and a high customer satisfaction percentage, Ravel has cemented its place as a pioneer in the individualized haircare industry. Today, Ravel thrives, with over 50 billion bespoke haircare product combinations to meet a wide range of needs. The brand's rise from Shark Tank triumph to beauty industry prominence exemplifies the potential of individualized solutions and customer-centric innovation. As Ravel's global reach and influence grow, the company stays committed to providing effective, natural, and personalized haircare solutions to people throughout the world.

Ravel's path from inception to its stunning presence on Shark Tank demonstrates the transforming power of tailored beauty solutions. Ravel has carved out a space for itself in the competitive beauty market by stressing individual needs, transparency, and innovation, while also inspiring a new wave of consumer-centric initiatives. As the brand grows and evolves, it is committed to providing effective, natural, and personalized haircare solutions. Ravel's success story serves as a reminder of the limitless possibilities that emerge when passion, devotion, and a customer-first approach come together, pointing to a future where personalized beauty experiences reign supreme.

DIVYA PATHAK
FY-MBA FINANCE
DIV 9

“NO DEAL, BIG DREAMS: THEKA COFFEE'S RISE AFTER SHARK TANK REJECTION”

Theka Coffee’s story is one of resilience and redefining success. Launched in 2017, Bhupinder Madaan, a young entrepreneur, craved a coffee experience that was both premium and affordable. Inspired by q quirky idea in a Delhi bar, Theka started brewing fresh, 100% Arabica coffee and serving it in wait for it- beer bottles! Their target audience? Millennials like himself craved a good cup of joe but weren’t keen on the high prices of fancy cafes.

Their journey wasn’t a smooth latte. Initially, they set up shop on Ahmedabad’s streets, brewing and selling coffee from a parked car. But the concept was a hit- strong coffee, catchy names like “Palangtod” (meaning “roof-shattering”), and unique packaging resonated with the crowd. Soon, they expanded their menu with flavors like “Chocolatey Patola” and “Desi Santra”, further solidifying their place in the Indian coffee scene.

Theka initiated a risky move in 2022 when they submitted their concept to Shark Tank India. Even if they were unable to obtain finance, the publicity changed everything. Potential franchises’ phones went off the hook after the program created a nationwide buzz. What had begun as a street vendor quickly became a national name.

As Theka’s story suggests, success sometimes depends on securing a large investment. They succeeded by concentrating on a high-quality product, creative packaging, and a distinctive brand identity. As a result of their diligence and ability to create success without the initial Shark Tank deal, Theka now has over 55 franchises across India

TEJAL SATIJA
DIV 4
FY MBA

CONCLUSION

In wrapping up this insightful exploration of Eco Sustainable Entrepreneurship, the journeys shared by the founders of Ravel, DoorBot, Theka Coffee, Kunafa World, Pharmallama, AI Cars, and Nish Hair unveil a promising horizon for sustainable business practices. These narratives transcend mere inspiration, offering profound insights and opportunities for students and the wider economy.

For students, the stories of Ravel, Theka Coffee, Kunafa World, Pharmallama, AI Cars, and Nish Hair serve as invaluable lessons, illustrating how sustainable principles can drive innovation, economic growth, and societal well-being. Entrepreneurs, through their experiences, become mentors, showcasing that success is about more than just financial gain—it's about making a positive impact on our planet.

Engaging with these environmentally conscious leaders sparks creativity, fosters critical thinking, and instills a sense of responsibility in the next generation of entrepreneurs. They understand the importance of balancing profit with environmental and social stewardship.

Beyond academia, the economic benefits are significant. The companies featured here exemplify how sustainable business models can bolster economic resilience, create jobs, and enhance market competitiveness. By embracing principles like the circular economy, businesses such as Ravel, Theka Coffee, Kunafa World, Pharmallama, AI Cars, and Nish Hair contribute to resource efficiency, waste reduction, and environmental preservation.

In essence, the stories shared in this exploration reveal a symbiotic relationship between sustainable entrepreneurship, education, and economic prosperity. They serve as a call to action for students and economic stakeholders alike, urging them to embrace sustainable practices for a greener, more resilient future. Let us draw inspiration from the journeys of these companies as we work towards a world where entrepreneurship not only thrives but also leads the way toward a sustainable and prosperous tomorrow.

DIVYA PATHAK
FY-MBA FINANCE
DIV 9

BUSINESS JARGONS

- **Dorsal Diplomacy:** Refers to the strategic negotiation tactics employed by entrepreneurs in the face of relentless scrutiny from the "Sharks

- **Fin-fluencers:** Influential figures within the entrepreneurial community who wield significant power in shaping market perceptions and investment trends.

- **Chumming the Waters**: The art of creating hype and anticipation around one's business, enticing potential investors and customers alike

- **Luring Bait:** A compelling proposition or unique selling point designed to captivate the interest of investors, akin to a tantalizing lure in the ocean of competition.

- **Depth Charges:** Unexpected challenges or hurdles encountered during the entrepreneurial journey, capable of sinking even the most promising ventures.

- **Reef Resilience:** The ability of entrepreneurs to adapt and thrive in adverse conditions, akin to coral reefs enduring turbulent seas.

- **Whirlpool Wealth:** Sudden influxes of capital or resources resulting from successful pitches or strategic partnerships, propelling ventures towards exponential growth.

- **Echoes of Ebb and Flow:** The cyclical nature of market trends and consumer preferences, necessitating agile navigation by entrepreneurs to stay afloat amidst turbulent currents.

- **Tide Turners:** Critical decisions or pivotal moments that dramatically alter the trajectory of a venture, either propelling it towards unprecedented success or relegating it to obscurity.

- **Barb-Wire Balance:** The delicate equilibrium between assertiveness and flexibility required by entrepreneurs when engaging in negotiations with investors, ensuring mutually beneficial outcomes.

VAISHNAVI SRIVASTAVA

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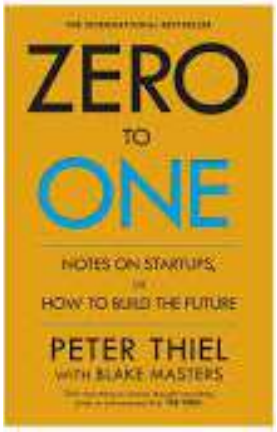
SUGGESTION BOX



Two Books -

- “The Lean Startup” by Eric Ries
- “Zero to One: Notes on Startups, or How to Build the Future” by Peter Thiel and Blake Masters

Two Courses -

- “How to Start a Startup”
- “Entrepreneurship Specialization”

SHIPRA SHASHWAT
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MEET THE COMMITTEE

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Aditya Gupta	Vice President
Rachiket Shetti	General Secretary
Kunal Mahure	General Advisor & Treasurer
Anurag	Creative Head
Nitish Golechha	Creative Co-Head
Aniket Sarda	Sponsorship Head
Saurab Jariyal	Event Head
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Moreover you can share your articles with us at

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Note: Articles should be on topics related to Entrepreneurship along with your name, specialization, year, contact number , email id and a formal photograph.
Word limit: 250-300 words.